Cloudwalk, In.

TECHNICAL CHALLENGE

Position: Talent Acquisition | Laura de Paula Machado

1. INTRODUCTION

Before initiating the documentation, it is important to mention that the dataset combines two different concepts in a single column: **sourcing channel** (where the candidate was found - LinkedIn, Github, Comunidade, Banco de Talentos, Evento, Indicação) and **sourcing motion** (how they entered the funnel - Inbound meaning the candidate applied proactively, Outbound/Hunting meaning the recruiter actively sourced them).

This limits the depth of the analysis. For example, a recruiter can hunt through LinkedIn, Github, or Comunidade - but in the current structure, Hunting appears as a standalone channel, making it impossible to know which platform it came from. The same applies to Inbound, which describes candidate behavior rather than a specific source.

Results below are presented as-is to preserve data integrity, with this limitation in mind, but I would highly recommend adding a separate column to capture sourcing motion (Inbound vs Outbound), keeping the channel column exclusively for platforms and sources. This would allow comparisons like "Outbound via LinkedIn vs Outbound via Github" - which is currently invisible in the data.

A second observation worth noting: the dataset contains two roles - Analista de Recrutamento and Talent Acquisition Specialist - that may overlap in scope depending on the company's internal structure. It is unclear whether this distinction reflects two genuinely different roles or a nomenclature variation. The data was kept as-is without merging the two, but this should be validated with the recruiting team before drawing role-specific conclusions.

2. DATA PREPARATION, AI AND TOOLING

Before initiating the analysis, logical columns (TRUE/FALSE) were transformed into numeric values (1/0) to enable correct extraction of metrics. A time-to-fill column was also added, calculated as the difference between the hired date and the first contact date, to enable time-based analysis by channel and position.

AI was used in all stages. I use Claude primarily to help me surface insights that would require significant time to extract manually in a spreadsheet (example is the identification of candidates scoring ≥75 across all three evaluations are most likely to get hired; or the analysis of other qualitative answers, such as reject reasons). Claude was also used to support the development of this document and to optimize the overall workflow, enabling a depth of analysis that would not be feasible within the available time working in spreadsheets alone.

The interactive dashboard was built using HTML, also with AI (Claude). Excel and pivot tables were used as the primary analysis tool for data exploration and validation.

Key decisions made throughout the analysis:

Preserving data integrity over manipulation: channels were not merged or recategorized even where overlaps were identified (e.g. Github and Hunting as outbound motion / Linkedin can be Inbound and Outbound). Instead, the limitation was documented and a recommendation for future data collection was included.

Excluding low-sample results from recommendations: any channel/role combination with fewer than 15 candidates was treated with caution and excluded from primary recommendations, even when the conversion rate appeared strong. Statistical reliability matters more than impressive-looking numbers.

3. **KEY INSIGHTS**

The bottleneck is not sourcing: it is the Test to Offer decision: The funnel is healthy through every stage until the test. Only 31% of candidates who complete the test receive an offer. This is the single highest-impact improvement opportunity in the entire recruitment process.

Github and Inbound are the most efficient channels overall (but channel choice should vary by role): There is no universal best channel. Banco de Talentos works best for Analista de Recrutamento (21%). LinkedIn for Talent Acquisition Specialist and Analista de Dados (13-15%). Comunidade for People BP (15%). It is worth noting that these results could change significantly if sourcing channel and sourcing motion were properly distinguished in the data - for example, Github and Hunting likely represent outbound motion rather than standalone channels, and LinkedIn can operate as both inbound and outbound depending on how it is used. A cleaner data structure would likely surface different and more precise channel rankings per role.

Inbound is the most consistent engagement signal across the entire dataset: Candidates who apply proactively show higher response rates, progress further through the funnel, and accept offers at higher rates. Inbound quality is not just about conversion - it is a behavioral signal that persists through the entire process.

Candidate scores are the strongest predictor of hire: Candidates scoring ≥75 across all three evaluations (technical, behavior and manager) are 5x more likely to be hired. This single signal can serve as a fast-track flag in high-volume processes.

Work mode impacts conversion as much as channel choice: Híbrido roles convert at 10.8% vs 5% for Remoto. Channel effectiveness changes completely depending on work mode: LinkedIn converts at 17% for Presencial but only 3% for Remoto. Github Híbrido reaches 20%, the highest single combination in the dataset. Channel strategy cannot be evaluated without considering the work mode of the role.

Indicação (referrals) underperforms every other channel: Referrals are universally assumed to be high quality - pre-vetted candidates with cultural context. The data contradicts this entirely: Indicação has the worst conversion rate (4.7%) and the lowest response rate (59%) in the dataset. This challenges a very common recruiting assumption and suggests the referral process may lack qualification criteria - candidates are referred regardless of fit. Referrals should be treated like any other channel and held to the same screening standards.

4. OTHER RECOMMENDATIONS

For remote openings, adjust sourcing strategy: prioritize LinkedIn and Banco de Talentos for remote positions.

For Analista de Dados specifically: 90% pass the interview but only 24% receive an offer - evaluation criteria may be too restrictive. Also salary mismatch is the second most common rejection reason for this role (6.6%). The data suggests the issue is not candidate qualification but attractiveness. If salary bands are not competitive for this profile, no sourcing optimization will close the gap.

For People BP and Talent Acquisition Specialists, invest in more personalized first contact: both roles show no-response rates above 43%, the highest in the dataset.

Investigate what Bruno does differently: 100% offer acceptance and 15% hire rate with similar candidate profiles to the rest of the team suggests a process or communication advantage worth replicating. This is particularly relevant for Gustavo, who manages the largest pipeline (121 candidates) but loses nearly half of candidates at offer stage (55% acceptance rate) - a pattern that suggests expectation misalignment during the process rather than a sourcing or evaluation problem.

Formalize role specialization: assign Bruno and Carla to Analista de Recrutamento, Ana to People BP, Fernanda to Talent Acquisition Specialist.

Deprioritize Evento and Indicação: high volume, lowest conversion in the dataset. Redirect sourcing effort toward Github, Inbound, or role-specific channels.

Avoid opening Staff-level roles without confirmed headcount approval: 5.8% of Staff rejections are due to headcount closure mid-process, a significant waste of recruiter time.